

Perceived Stress Tracks the Tinnitus Symptom More Than the Audiometric Threshold: A Survey-Weighted KNHANES Study (STARS)

With a Prespecified Cross-National Validation Plan and a Clinician-Governed Referral-Safety Component

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Running head: Perceived Stress, Tinnitus, and Audiometric Thresholds

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Author Contributions (CRediT)

Geunsik Lim—Conceptualization, Methodology, Software, Formal analysis, Data curation, Writing (original draft & editing), Visualization. The author read and approved the manuscript.

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Conflicts of Interest

The author declares no competing interests.

AI-Use Disclosure

Generative AI tools assisted in drafting and structuring the manuscript and the code scaffold; the author reviewed and is responsible for all content. In the proposed study, open medical language models will be used only for research feature extraction and guideline-linked explanation from deidentified text, always with clinician verification before analysis and never for autonomous clinical decisions.

Data and Code Availability

Analysis code, configuration, variable-mapping templates, model cards, reporting checklists, and a synthetic-data generator are openly available at <https://github.com/leemgs/stars-audiology>. KNHANES data are available from the Korea Disease Control and Prevention Agency subject to official access procedures; NHANES public-use files are available from the U.S. CDC. Restricted raw data are not redistributed.